

EDITION UNITED STATES · 2026 REPORT

# What it really costs to buy in Portugal

Taxes, mortgages and worked examples for buyers who live abroad, with the official source for every number.

Imóveis Portugal

Facts checked on October 24 and 25, 2026

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AT A GLANCE

| | |
|---|---|
| 7.5% | transfer tax (IMT) for buyers who aren't Portuguese tax residents, since May 2026, with some exceptions. |
| 0.8% | stamp duty on the price, for every buyer. |
| 80% | of the value is the most a bank can lend for a home that isn't your main residence. |

HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

Every number has an official source, listed at the end with the date we checked it. We describe the rules; we don't give advice. Partner pages are labeled as sponsored content.

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Sponsored by Habinedita Gondomar

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Habinedita Gondomar works with buyers who live outside Portugal, with experience serving clients from Luxembourg, France, Switzerland, Brazil, the United States and Israel. The agency handles the search, viewings and negotiation, and works with lawyers and banks for buyers purchasing from abroad.

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01 PURCHASE TAXES

# Purchase taxes

The property transfer tax (IMT) is due on the day it's assessed or within the following 30 days. For residents, the 2026 rates depend on how the home is used. The value is split in two: up to the previous bracket limit at that bracket's average rate, and the rest at the marginal rate.

### Main home (owner-occupied)

| Value up to | Marginal rate | Average rate at the limit |
|---|---|---|
| 106,346 € | 0% | 0% |
| 145,470 € | 2% | 0.5379% |
| 198,347 € | 5% | 1.7274% |
| 330,539 € | 7% | 3.8361% |
| Up to 660,982 € | 8% | – |

### Other home, such as a vacation home

| Value up to | Marginal rate | Average rate at the limit |
|---|---|---|
| 106,346 € | 1% | 1% |
| 145,470 € | 2% | 1.2689% |
| 198,347 € | 5% | 2.2636% |
| 330,539 € | 7% | 4.1578% |
| Up to 633,931 € | 8% | – |

Above these values: 6% (flat) up to 1,150,853 € and 7.5% above.

02 NON-RESIDENTS AND STAMP DUTY

# 7.5%

Since May 2026 (Decree-Law 97/2026), buyers who aren't Portuguese tax residents pay IMT at a flat 7.5% on homes, with no exemption or reduction. The rate doesn't apply when the buyer:

a. has been considered a Portuguese tax resident;

b. becomes a Portuguese tax resident within two years of the purchase;

c. rents the home out as a residence within six months, at a rent within the decree's caps, for at least 36 months in the first five years.

In the last two cases you pay 7.5% first and claim back the difference within six months. How the first exception applies to people who once lived in Portugal is a question for a lawyer or tax advisor.

## Stamp duty

| | |
|---|---|
| 0.8% | of the value, at purchase |
| 0.6% | of the amount borrowed, with a loan of five years or more |
| 4% | on the interest charged by the bank |

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03 WORKED EXAMPLES

# Worked examples

Purchase taxes, rounded to the euro, using the 2026 tables. Excludes the deed, registration, legal fees, currency exchange and mortgage costs.

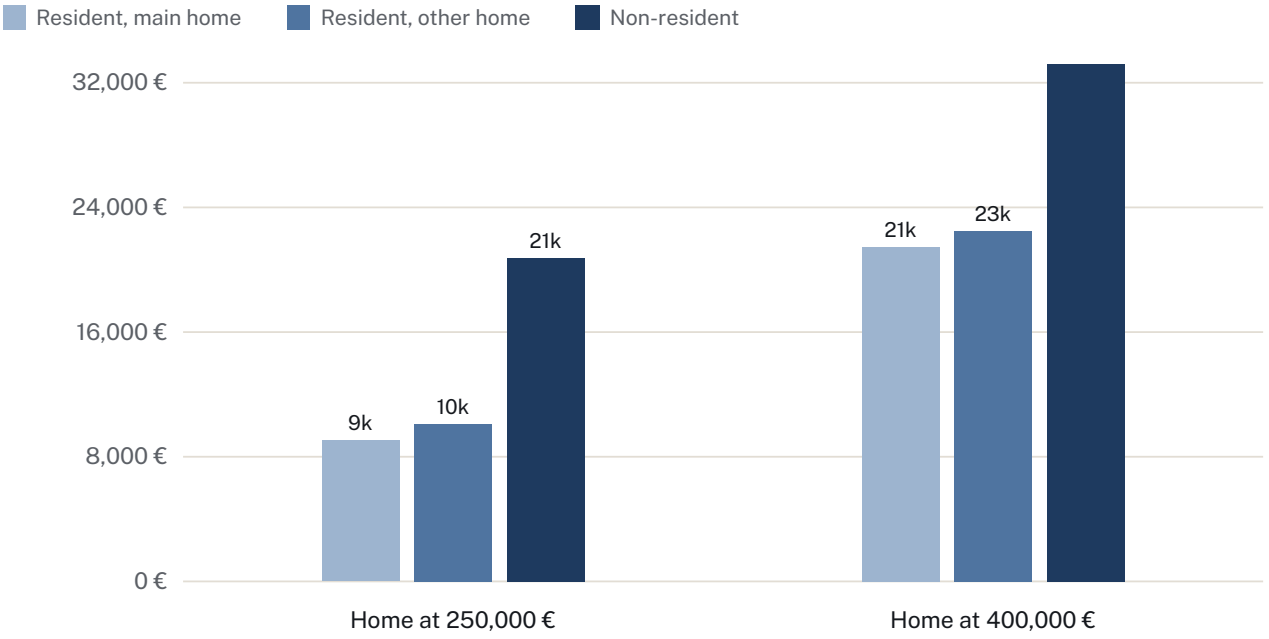
### Home at 250,000 €

| | Resident, main home | Resident, other home | Non-resident |
|---|---|---|---|
| IMT | 7,042 € | 8,105 € | 18,750 € |
| Stamp duty (0.8%) | 2,000 € | 2,000 € | 2,000 € |
| **Total** | **9,042 €** | **10,105 €** | **20,750 €** |

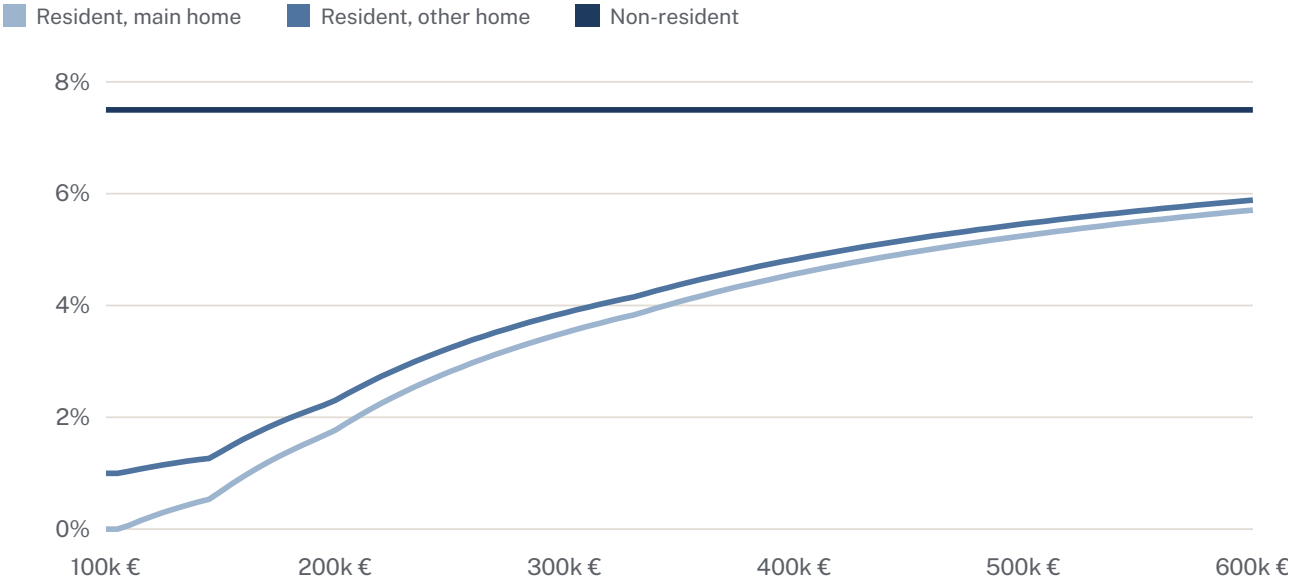
### Home at 400,000 €

| | Resident, main home | Resident, other home | Non-resident |
|---|---|---|---|
| IMT | 18,237 € | 19,300 € | 30,000 € |
| Stamp duty (0.8%) | 3,200 € | 3,200 € | 3,200 € |
| **Total** | **21,437 €** | **22,500 €** | **33,200 €** |

## Purchase taxes by buyer profile




## Effective transfer tax rate by price




IMT divided by the price, using the 2026 tables.

04 MORTGAGES

# Mortgages

| | |
|---|---|
| 90% | of the value at most for your main home; 80% for other uses. The lower of the price and the appraisal counts. |
| 45% | of net income is the cap on the payments of all your loans together (each bank may exceed it for up to 10% of the credit it grants per year). |
| 40 years | maximum term if you're 35 or younger; 35 years from that age. |

Banco de Portugal rules applying since August 1, 2026.

### How much cash you need

Example: a non-resident buys a 300,000 € vacation home with the maximum 80% loan.

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment (20%) | 60,000 € |
| IMT (7.5%) | 22,500 € |
| Stamp duty on the purchase (0.8%) | 2,400 € |
| Stamp duty on the loan (0.6% of 240,000 €) | 1,440 € |
| **Total paid from your own funds** | **86,340 €** |

Excludes the deed, registration, legal fees, appraisal, currency exchange and the 4% stamp duty on interest, which is paid over the life of the loan.

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EDITION UNITED STATES

# If you live in the United States

- Tax representative: the United States is outside the EU and the EEA. After the purchase you have 15 days to appoint a tax representative in Portugal or sign up for the tax authority's electronic notifications.
- IMT: if you are not a Portuguese tax resident, you pay the flat 7.5%. If you become a Portuguese tax resident within two years of the purchase, you pay 7.5% first and claim back the difference within six months.
- FBAR: US persons file an FBAR with FinCEN, separately from the tax return, when the combined value of their foreign accounts goes over $10,000 at any time in the year.
- Form 8938: for taxpayers living outside the US, it applies with foreign assets over $200,000 at year end or $300,000 at any time (single; $400,000 and $600,000 joint). The thresholds for people living in the US differ and are not covered here.
- Selling: under the Portugal–US tax treaty, Portugal may tax gains on property in Portugal, and the US keeps the right to tax its citizens. The foreign tax credit (Form 1116) avoids double taxation.

Not covered here: the filing rules of the country where you live depend on your situation. Talk to a tax adviser.

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05 THE STEPS AND THE YEARLY TAXES

# The steps and the yearly taxes

1. NIF: the Portuguese tax number can be requested online through a legal representative, or in person. No tax representative is needed to get it.
2. Power of attorney: sign it at a Portuguese consulate or before a notary where you live; in that case it needs a Hague Apostille.
3. Promissory contract (CPCV): it sets the price, date and deposit. If the buyer backs out through their own fault, they lose the deposit; if the seller does, the buyer can claim double (Civil Code, art. 442).
4. Origin of funds: banks, notaries and lawyers must ask where the money comes from when the transaction calls for it (Law 83/2017).
5. IMT and stamp duty: paid before closing, within the assessment deadline.
6. After the purchase: if you live outside the EU, you have 15 days to appoint a tax representative or sign up for the tax authority's electronic notices.

**Every year**

| | |
|---|---|
| **IMI** | 0.3% to 0.45% of the property's tax value, at the rate set by the municipality. |
| **AIMI** | only on total tax values above 600,000 € per person. |
| **Rent** | residential rent earned by non-residents is taxed at 25% in Portugal, with reductions for long leases. |
| **Sale** | for Portuguese income tax, 50% of the gain counts. |

# Checklist and glossary

- [ ] I have a NIF
- [ ] I know whether I'll become a tax resident within two years
- [ ] I have quotes for the deed, registration and fees
- [ ] I asked the bank for a simulation with the appraisal
- [ ] I have proof of where the money comes from
- [ ] I had the promissory contract reviewed
- [ ] I have a power of attorney with an Apostille, or a consulate appointment
- [ ] I appointed a tax representative or signed up for electronic notices (15 days)

**Glossary**

| | |
|---|---|
| **IMT** | Transfer tax paid when buying property. |
| **IMI** | Yearly municipal property tax. |
| **AIMI** | Additional IMI on high property values. |
| **NIF** | Portuguese tax number. |
| **CPCV** | Promissory purchase contract. |
| **Sinal** | Deposit paid on the promissory contract. |
| **Escritura** | The deed that transfers ownership (closing). |
| **VPT** | The property's tax value, the basis for IMI. |

07 SOURCES

# Sources

Official sources, with the date we checked each one.


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## Need help with your own case?

We pass your request to a partner lawyer, bank, tax advisor or money transfer service. For buying or selling a home, our licensed partner agency.

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